The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which products and services are growing?

Period: September 2026. Revenue, gross margin and growth (year on year) by product or service line over 24 months. Pick a line and every number, chart and note follows it.

How final is this data?

September 2026 Locked September 2026 is locked (closed 2 Oct 2026). These numbers won't change.

Trades

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

September's jobs made $96,230 gross margin (42.7%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $28,417 and overheads $59,580, leaving $8,233 profit before tax (3.7% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 39.0% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	$96,230
Technician wages and on-costs	$79,587
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	$51,170
Technician time not charged to jobs	$28,417
Gross profit (the P&L)	$67,813
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$59,580
Profit before tax (the P&L)	$8,233
Revenue	$225,460
Gross margin on jobs, %	42.7%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	3.7%
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**39.0%**

Line: All

September against September last year
57.6%
$225,460 against $143,077

Year to date against the same period last year
26.4%
$640,593 against $506,783

Gross margin, year to date
44.3%
$283,869 before overheads

What it shows

Revenue is 26.4% up on the same period last year, year to date ($640,593 against $506,783). Maintenance contracts make the highest gross margin (63.9%); Installations the lowest (37.0%). The business needs 39.0% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 37.0% gross margin, 2.0 points over the 35.0% target ($8,257 ahead on $412,100 this financial year to date). Maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($39,281 ahead on $136,050 this financial year to date).

Line: Maintenance contracts

September against September last year
21.9%
$45,350 against $37,200

Year to date against the same period last year
21.9%
$136,050 against $111,600

Gross margin, year to date
63.9%
$86,898 before overheads

What it shows
Maintenance contracts brought in $136,050 this financial year to date, 21.9% on the same period last year (slower than the business as a whole, 26.4%), at a 63.9% gross margin (above the 44.3% overall).

What you'd do about it
Maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($39,281 ahead on $136,050 this financial year to date).

Line: Installations

September against September last year
73.8%
$146,300 against $84,200

Year to date against the same period last year
23.8%
$412,100 against $332,800

Gross margin, year to date
37.0%
$152,492 before overheads

What it shows
Installations brought in $412,100 this financial year to date, 23.8% on the same period last year (slower than the business as a whole, 26.4%), at a 37.0% gross margin (below the 44.3% overall).

What you'd do about it
Installations: 37.0% gross margin, 2.0 points over the 35.0% target ($8,257 ahead on $412,100 this financial year to date).

Line: Call-outs and repairs

September against September last year
56.0%
$33,810 against $21,677

Year to date against the same period last year
48.2%
$92,443 against $62,383

Gross margin, year to date
48.1%
$44,479 before overheads

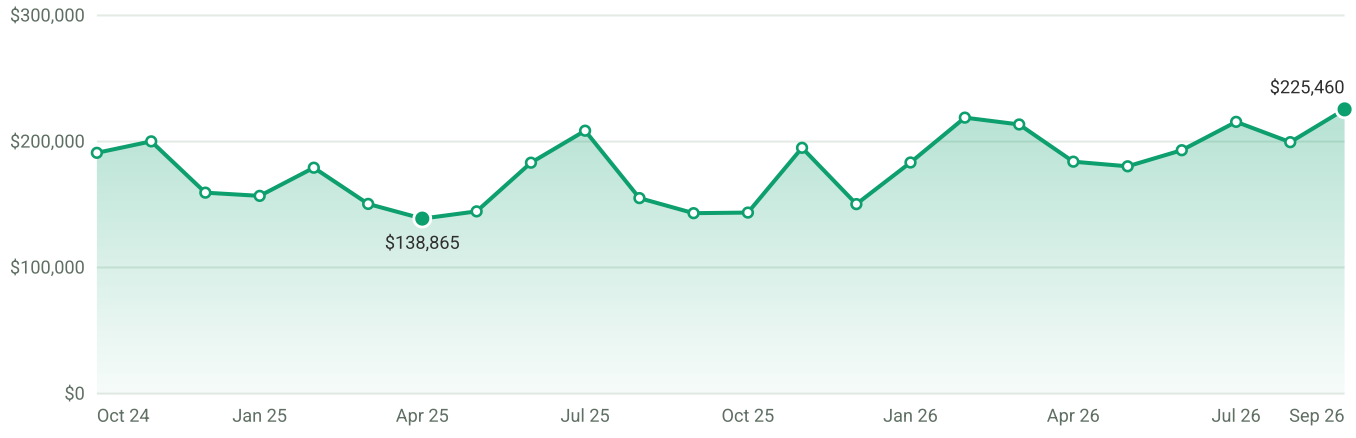
What it shows
Call-outs and repairs brought in $92,443 this financial year to date, 48.2% on the same period last year (faster than the business as a whole, 26.4%), at a 48.1% gross margin (above the 44.3% overall).

What you'd do about it
Call-outs and repairs: 48.1% gross margin, 13.1 points over the 35.0% target ($12,124 ahead on $92,443 this financial year to date).

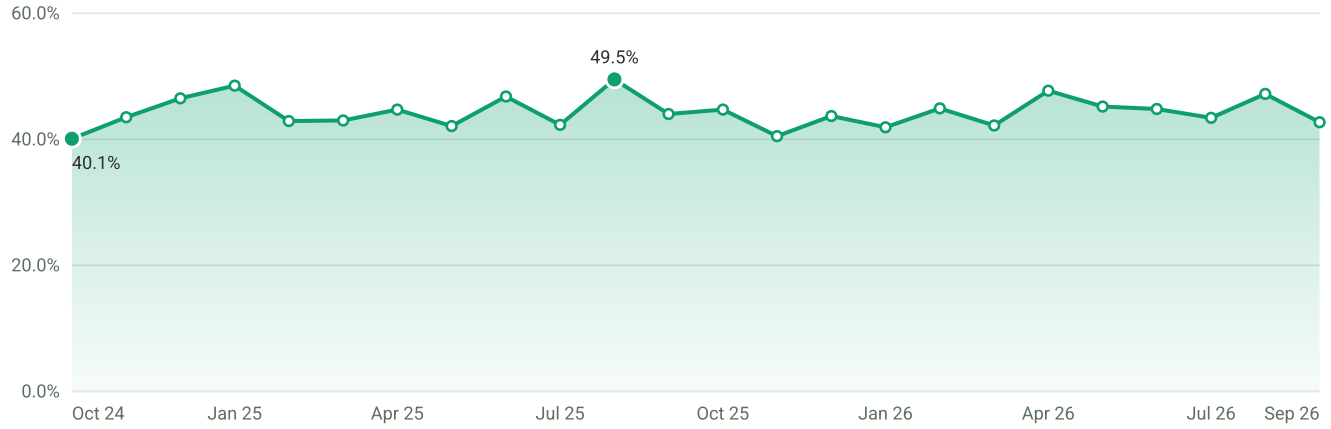
Every line at once

Revenue, gross margin and growth by line, by month

All · Revenue $



All · Gross margin %



Growth is year on year: each month against the same month a year earlier. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

By line: financial year to date (Jul to Sep 2026) against the same period last year

	Year to date	Same period last year	Growth	Gross margin $	Gross margin %
Maintenance contracts	$136,050	$111,600	21.9%	$86,898	63.9%
Installations	$412,100	$332,800	23.8%	$152,492	37.0%
Call-outs and repairs	$92,443	$62,383	48.2%	$44,479	48.1%
Total	$640,593	$506,783	26.4%	$283,869	44.3%

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.